



IN DETAIL

Collar stands clear
of the dress



Dropped
waistline
falls into
a deep V

**◁ BACK FASTENING**

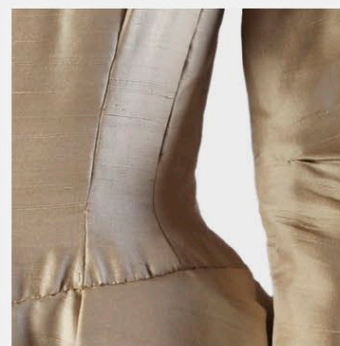
A fashionable long zip runs down the back of the dress from the deep, curved V of the neckline. The plunging V of antique lace, and the inverted V of the dropped waistline at the back, mirror the shape to gorgeous effect. The back of a wedding dress is particularly important as this is what the guests see during the marriage service.

**◁ LACE COLLAR**

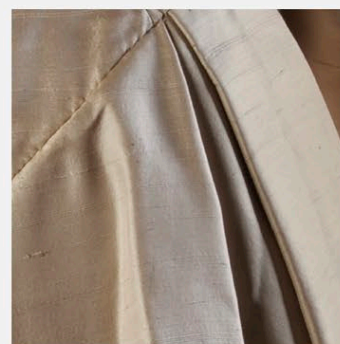
The front of the dress is completely plain apart from the embellishment of a deep band of 19th-century lace, thought to be a type of Brussels lace called "Duchesse". It was donated to the bride by an elderly friend. Re-using lace and other fabrics has a long tradition to do with the expense of textiles as well as the sentiment attached to them.

**◁ BOAT NECKLINE**

The stiffened lace at shoulder height is cut wide to flatten the neck and shoulders, and creates the illusion of a cap sleeve, popular on wedding dresses at the time.

**◁ SIDE SEAMS**

A perfect hourglass shape is produced using two sets of princess seams at each side of the bodice, running from the waist to the bust and armholes, with a further two seams at the back ending at shoulder-blade height. The dropped waist lengthens the body.

**◁ BOX-PLEATED SKIRT**

The skirt falls just below the knee, its width gathered into wide box pleats. Petticoats with Vilene (a synthetic stiffener) help to create the shape.